Where the name came from

As its spelling suggests, Deleuze and Guattari built the word from two parts. The first, "nomad-," reaches back through Laroche's philology to the Greek root *nem-*, and through Deleuze's own work to the nomad as a figure of thought, to which the steppe historians then gave peoples. The second, "-ology," comes from Leibniz's *Monadology*, though Deleuze and Guattari also set it against "a history," which is to say against the sedentary point of view from which history is written. Each row gives a source they used and what it gives the name.

In brief. The word was not in the 1977 list of names for the project (*Dialogues* 125), and Deleuze never said it in the 1979-80 seminar on capture and war machines. It arrived with the book in 1980, in four places at once: as something lacking, "the opposite of a history" 23, as one of Professor Challenger's aliases 43, as the title of plateau 12, and in the note where a monadology of opened units "should be superseded by a 'nomadology'" 574 n. 27. Its parts, however, are older: "nomad" goes back through Deleuze's 1972 talk and his 1968 "nomadic distribution" to Laroche's Greek. The form of the word comes from Leibniz. We have found no earlier use of "nomadology."

When	Where	What it says	What it brings to the name
A The word arrives, 1977 to 1980			
1977	*Dialogues* 125	In 1977 the project's names were "schizoanalysis, micro-politics, pragmatics, diagrammatism, rhizomatics, cartography"	Nomadology was not yet on the list, which by 1980 had gained one name and lost two
1979-80	Deleuze's seminar on apparatuses of capture and war machines (French and English transcripts)	Session after session, the seminar works through the nomads and the war machine at length	Deleuze never uses the word in these sessions, so it arrived with the book and not in the classroom
1980	*A Thousand Plateaus*, plateaus 1, 3 and 12 23, 43, 351	"What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history" (23). Professor Challenger, the scientist borrowed from Conan Doyle, calls his discipline by seven names: "rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, nomadology, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities" (43). And it is the title, "Treatise on Nomadology" (351)	In its first uses the word names a lack, an alias and a treatise, all in the same book
B "Nomad-": the Greek root *nem-*			
1949	Emmanuel Laroche, *Histoire de la racine nem- en grec ancien* 115-21, cited in DR and ATP	In Homer, *nomós* is the pasture, "un espace illimité" ("an unlimited space"). The sense of law, *nómos*, came later. *Nomádes* is "an adjective" that names "a way of life, not a nation" 121	Named from a way of grazing across open land, the nomad comes before any people or law
1968	*Difference and Repetition* 36-37 and n. 6	A "nomadic distribution," a nomos "without property, enclosure or measure," taken from Laroche	Deleuze first joins *nomos* and *nomad* here, twelve years before the word. What he means can only be *nomós*, the pasture (Zartaloudis 141)
1969	*The Logic of Sense* 102, 107, 263	Singularities with "a mobile, immanent principle of auto-unification through a nomadic distribution" (102), Nietzsche's "nomadic singularities" (107), and "the world of nomadic distributions and crowned anarchies" (263)	The 1968 phrase recurs through the book, and "nomadic" comes to describe singularities, not peoples
1980	Plateau 12 380 and n. 51	"The nomos came to designate the law, but that was originally because it was distribution," "without division into shares, in a space without borders or enclosure"	Inside the chapter that bears the word, the treatise repeats the philology
C "Nomad-": the nomad as a figure			
1972	Deleuze, "Nomad Thought" 146-49	In this talk on Nietzsche, philosophy "is born out of the imperial state," and the nomad "is not necessarily one who moves"	Eight years before the word, the nomad becomes a figure of thought against the State. Dosse names Nietzsche "a major source of inspiration" for it (*Intersecting Lives* 135)

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Where the name came from, continued

When	Where	What it says	What it brings to the name
D "Nomad-": the studies of nomads in the notes History is written "from the sedentary point of view ... even when the topic is nomads" 23			
1377	Ibn Khaldun, *Muqaddimah* (ATP 366, 481, 555 n. 31, 557 n. 51)	Bedouinism, "the bedouin life-style, not the ethnic group," set against city living, and a nomad war machine defined by "families or lineages PLUS esprit de corps" (366, 555 n. 31). For Ibn Khaldun, "Bedouins are prior to sedentary people"	Of the studies in the notes, this is the oldest and the nearest to a nomadology. The plateaus keep his pair and reverse its order: "it is the town that invents agriculture" (481)
1934	Toynbee, *A Study of History* (Somervell 168-69; ATP 381, 482)	Farmers who emigrate "changed their habitat in order not to change their habits," while the others "flung themselves upon the Steppe ... to make themselves at home on it." Nomadism is "a society without a history" (169)	"Toynbee is profoundly right" that the nomad "does not move" (381). The plateaus keep his nomad and drop his verdict that nomadism is an arrested civilization
1934 and 1939	Vladimirtsov, *Le régime social des Mongols* (French 1948), and Grousset, *L'Empire des steppes* (ATP 394, 560 nn. 71, 73, 574 n. 30, 575 n. 37)	Here are the Soviet and the bourgeois histories of the steppe. Vladimirtsov gives the nomads a "feudal interpretation" (560 n. 73), and Grousset traces the art of the steppes and its "slowness"	Both belong to the historians who "consider the nomads a pitiable segment of humanity that understands nothing" (394), and the plateaus draw on them anyway
1948	Pierre Hubac, *Les nomades* (ATP 382, 557 n. 53)	Nomadism is explained less by universal changes of climate than by the "divagation of local climates"	Hubac wrote a whole book on nomads, which the plateaus credit before they correct it, since he "tends to confuse nomads and migrants" (557 n. 53)
1954 to 1978	Emperaire, Thesiger, Carpenter and Milovanoff on nomad space (ATP 382, 557 nn. 49, 54-56)	Emperaire's "nomads of the sea" take an itinerary "from campsite to campsite." Thesiger's sand desert and Carpenter's ice desert show "a whole minor science of qualitative variables and traces." Among Milovanoff's Larbaa nomads, "the dwelling is tied not to a territory but rather to an itinerary"	From these comes the nomad of smooth space, a way of dwelling and of finding one's way, so that the word keeps its nomads without naming a people
1969	Mikhail Griaznov, *The Ancient Civilization of Southern Siberia* (ATP 430, 565 n. 13)	"it was the sedentary farmers who went out on the steppe and became nomadic, during the Bronze Age"	Nomadism becomes "a movement, a becoming that affects sedentaries" (430), and so the nomad follows the town
1979	Kenneth White, *Intellectual Nomadism*, unpublished (ATP 379 and n. 47)	A "properly nomad thought" drawn from the marriage of "the Celt and the Orient"	Alone in the notes, White offers a nomadology of thought, which the plateaus take up with a warning that the theme of a race can turn "into a racism"
E "-ology": monadology, and the opposite of a history			
1714	Leibniz, *Monadology*, as Deleuze taught it in April 1980	This is the title on which the word is built. In the course, monads are closed "because there is no exterior"	*Nomad* is an anagram of *monad*, and *nomadology* of *monadology*
1969	*The Logic of Sense* 113-14	In "the theater of Leibniz" there is "a 'vague Adam,' that is, a vagabond, a nomad, an Adam = x common to several worlds"	The first passage to set the nomad beside Leibniz, eleven years before the word. The route runs from "vague" to "vagabond," as at ATP 367
1980	Plateau 14 574 n. 27, after Gilles Châtelet, "Sur une petite phrase de Riemann" (1979)	Once monads are "no longer thought to be closed upon themselves" and enter "step-by-step local relations," "the purely monadological point of view proves inadequate and should be superseded by a 'nomadology'"	It is the only passage that makes the word out of another word, so that nomadology is monadology with its units opened
1977 and 1980	*Dialogues* 31, plateau 1 23	"Nomads have no history, they only have geography" (*Dialogues* 31). "What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history" (23)	The "-ology" names a kind of account set against history, not a science of nomads
	François Dosse, *Intersecting Lives* 257	Dosse reads the title "Treatise on Nomadology" as "a serious and yet ironic reference" to Spinoza's *Theological-Political Treatise*	This is Dosse's reading of the word "Treatise," which Deleuze and Guattari never state
F After 1980			
1986	Semiotext(e)	*Nomadology: The War Machine*, plateau 12 printed alone in English	With this booklet the word became the English name for the treatise, cut off from plateau 13 and from the monadology note
1987	Kenneth White, *L'Esprit nomade* 46-53	A section titled "Nomadologie française" gathers a French current, 1966 to 1984, that drew on the same steppe books as ATP	White applies the label backward, to a current that includes ATP, and we have found no use of the word before 1980
1988	*The Fold* 137, *Negotiations* 152-53	Monads "kept half open as if by a pair of pliers" "overtake monadology with a 'nomadology'" (*Fold* 137). Interviewers quote the word back, "you set out a 'nomadology'" (*Negotiations* 152)	Deleuze uses the word again for the opened monad, with no steppe in it
1991	*What Is Philosophy?* 95-96	"Philosophy is a geophilosophy in precisely the same way that history is a geohistory from Braudel's point of view" (95)	Deleuze and Guattari's later name for the claim against history

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Approaches that come close

Several approaches outside Deleuze and Guattari's orbit come close to nomadology. Instead of grading them, the sheet ends each row on the question that would turn its concept toward a nomadology. The "Part" column says which part of the name each approach touches, with "-ology" standing for the claim against history. The numbers point to the guiding problems on the back of the sheet on royal and nomad science.

Concept	Works	Where it comes close	Part	Problem	The question it opens
Pastoral power	Foucault, *Security, Territory, Population* (1977-78 lectures), with Toynbee, *A Study of History* (1934)	A power exercised "not over a territory" but over "the flock in its movement" (125, cited in Zartaloudis 139), caring for each one and for all together. Toynbee sees it from the nomad's side, conquerors who become "shepherds of men" over subjects whose name means "flock" (Somervell 172, 182). Like nomadology, it starts from a multiplicity on the move	nomos	3, 6	*When a power tends a flock on the move, each one and all together, is the flock composed by its own movement or by the shepherd's count?*
Nomos as use	Zartaloudis, *The Birth of Nomos* (2019)	Nomos as a field of coexisting uses that jurists later projected back as law. A nomos, following Hirzel, is "a power that is; not a power that is 'had'" (xxxvii)	nomos	1	*If nomos was first a way of life, what had to be converted before it could be presented as a law that was always there?*
Nomos as appropriation	Schmitt, *The Nomos of the Earth* (1950)	The same word, and the question of how the earth is ordered, with taking first, dividing second and pasture last	nomos	1, 7	*When an order dates itself from an act of taking, what does it make of the life that came before it?*
Legibility	Scott, *Seeing Like a State* (1998), *The Art of Not Being Governed* (2009)	Counting as the way a State makes a population legible, against local measures, and peoples who live beyond the reach of the count	-ology	3	*When flight is told as an escape from the State's count, how does the fleeing body count itself?*
Silences	Trouillot, *Silencing the Past* (1995)	Power enters the record at every stage, from the making of sources to the making of narratives	-ology	1	*When an archive is made by the power it records, what does that power present as its own invention?*
Linkages	Wolf, *Europe and the People without History* (1982)	"Wide-ranging linkages among populations" before European expansion (25), against a world of bounded societies spinning off each other like "billiard balls" (6)	nomad	4	*What moves between formations without belonging to any one of them?*
Seasonal variation	Graeber and Wengrow, *The Dawn of Everything* (2021)	Societies that changed their social form with the seasons, taking on a hierarchy for part of the year and setting it down again	nomad	2	*When a society takes on a hierarchy for one season, what keeps the season from becoming a change in kind?*
Dependence on the outside	Khazanov, *Nomads and the Outside World* (1983), Lindner, "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982)	No pastoral economy is self-sufficient. Lindner finds the tribe was "a political organism open to all who were willing to subordinate themselves to its chief" (701)	nomad	4, 5	*If no pastoral formation can live on its own, how does it stay open to the sedentary world without being divided by it?*

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Other names

Below are the names already in use and what a new name would need. Each route then ends on a suggested name. Apart from geophilosophy, which is Deleuze and Guattari's own, we have found none of them in use as a name.

Names already in use

Challenger's seven names. Rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, nomadology, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities 43

Geophilosophy. Deleuze and Guattari's own later name, for a philosophy that arises from "a geography rather than a historiography" (What Is Philosophy? 96). They credit Nietzsche with founding it (102)

The 1977 aliases. Schizoanalysis, micro-politics, pragmatics, diagrammatism, rhizomatics, cartography (Dialogues 125). Nomadology joined the series in 1980, and diagrammatism and cartography left it

Geopoetics. The name Kenneth White has used since the late 1970s for "cette densification de la géographie" ("this densification of geography") that the nomad must invent (L'Esprit nomade 11, 272-94). A rival name in use, with the nomad kept outside politics

Minor science, nomad science. The science that follows its material, against royal science 361-74. It is the name of this site

Nomad thought. The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, and of the thought set against the State form 376-80

Mobile pastoralism. What steppe research now calls the way of life once named nomadism (Humphrey and Sneath). It names an economy, not a method

What a new name would need

1. It should not name a people. In Greek the word named a way of life, "not a nation" (Laroche 121)
2. It should keep the sense of distribution without division into shares, which plateau 12 takes from the Greek nomos 380
3. It should keep the opened monad of the Riemann note, in which each unit has direct relations with its neighbors 574 n. 27
4. It should put politics before being, as Guattari did first ("before Being there is politics," Dialogues 17) and A Thousand Plateaus repeats 203
5. If it ends in "-logy," it should say why, given the observation below
6. It should make sense to readers outside philosophy

Where one could come from

From nem-. A name for distribution without division into shares 380. **Suggested: Nemology.** The root nem- with "-logy." It also stays clear of "nomology," which already means the science of laws

From the nomad as a figure. A name for a way of life without a people, like Laroche's adjective nomádes 121, or for nomad thought ("Nomad Thought," 1972). **Suggested: Nomad thought.** The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, already set against the State form. Unlike Braidotti's "nomadic subjects," it names a thought and not a self

From the monad. A name for the monad once it is opened and joined to its neighbors 574 n. 27. **Suggested: Open monadology.** Leibniz's word kept, minus the closure the Riemann note removes

From the opposite of a history. A name for geography against history 23. **Suggested: Geophilosophy.** Deleuze and Guattari's own name from 1991, already in use (What Is Philosophy? 95-96)

From minor science. A name for the science that follows its material 361-74. **Suggested: Ambulant science, or vagabond science.** Both are Deleuze and Guattari's own words, though neither has been a title: "the ambulant sciences" (372-74), and Husserl's "vague, in other words, vagabond or nomadic" essences (367). The Logic of Sense gives the same adjective to Leibniz's "vague Adam, that is, a vagabond, a nomad" (113-14)

From the path. A name for following place after place, in a space "explored only by legwork" 371. **Suggested: Periegetics.** From the Greek periēgēsis, "a leading around," the genre of Pausanias's tour of Greece, which describes each place as it comes. Kenneth White calls a wandering, anarchist method "une périegèse" ("a periegesis," L'Esprit nomade 58). It has no people in it and no "-logy"

From the word itself. Keep "nomadology" and tell its history, or add to Challenger's seven names 43, as the joke invites. **Suggested: Nemesiology, a name of our own, offered as an eighth for Challenger's list.** From the same root comes nemesis, the anger of the gods at anyone who takes more than a share, and Laroche puts it in his title as one of the root's four words. Such a name would keep the punishment in view, which is to say the very thing a distribution without shares escapes

Our own observation, which Deleuze and Guattari do not make, is that "nomado-logy" puts a logos over the nomos. Plateau 12 calls this move "the triumph of the logos or the law over the nomos" 373.

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